Hongming Qiu (Henry)

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Education

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

M.S. in Electrical and Computer Engineering (Thesis) — *Expected May 2028*

B.S. in Computer Engineering | Overall GPA: 3.99/4.00 | Highest Honors | Bronze Tablet — *August 2026*

Research Experience

Kernel Security Researcher — **September 2025 – Present**

UIUC | Advisor: Prof. Tianyin Xu | In collaboration with IBM Research [code] [LPC '26 talk]

- Designed and implemented Linux IMA extensions for policy-controlled **eBPF measurement and appraisal**, including TPM-backed attestation, PKCS#7 signature verification, and policy predicates over program and attachment types.
- Built **race-safe reappraisal and revocation** of resident eBPF programs using retained integrity metadata and RCU; removed references across links, pins, file descriptors, tail-call maps, and cgroup attachments.
- Integrated signed loading and recovery with Cilium; evaluated vulnerable datapath remediation and a concealed **eBPF rootkit** with zero residual programs across 34 purge configurations; wrote the resulting manuscript as first author.
- Reproducing OS-CFI's origin-sensitive design to evaluate **eBPF-based Linux kernel control-flow integrity**.

LLVM-Based Static Malware Detection Research — **February 2025 – Present**

Independent Research | Three-person team [code]

- Co-developed a polymorphic LLVM framework to evaluate **static antivirus evasion** on Windows and Linux.
- Designed the original **EliminateIAT** pass, rewriting imported calls through runtime LoadLibrary/GetProcAddress stubs while preserving LLVM invoke control flow and variadic call sites; led MSVC/LLVM toolchain integration for complex Windows codebases.
- Designed **Masquerade** to copy sections and imports from benign Windows programs and keep them from being removed during linking; improved string obfuscation to support complex access patterns.
- Evaluated 1,160 artifacts from seven malware families against up to 76 VirusTotal engines; measured **95.5% mean inter-build byte divergence** and sub-1% mean detection for the strongest pass combinations.

Selected Systems Projects

RISC-V Operating System Kernel | *C/C++, RISC-V Assembly* — **2024; 2026 – Present**

- Built a C kernel (ECE 391) with processes, IPC, and drivers; ported Doom and Rogue to student-built kernels.
- Porting the kernel to **C++23** for ECE 498OS with **multi-core support**, cooperative scheduling, RAII synchronization, runtime hooks, and polymorphic I/O.

Out-of-Order RISC-V Processor | *SystemVerilog, ECE 411, Team of 3* — **Spring 2026**

- Co-designed and verified a **2-way superscalar RV32IM processor**; implemented gshare and return-address prediction for a two-stage fetch pipeline, cutting mispredictions from about **60% to 10%**; sustained **over 1 IPC** at 500 MHz on compression and ray-tracing benchmarks.

Leadership & Teaching

Admin & Purple Team Lead — **September 2023 – Present**

SIGPwny, cybersecurity club at the University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

- Authored **30+ CTF challenges** for UIUCTF and SIGPwny; led numerous advanced workshops for 50+ club members.
- Built and maintained **multiple Proxmox instances** for a networking and security practice range, with **20+ VMs**, segmented networks, VPN access, and pfSense/OPNsense firewalls.

ECE 391 Teaching Assistant / Course Assistant — **January 2025 – Present**

ECE Department, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

- Lead discussions and support **20+ students weekly** in office hours for a 250+ student RISC-V OS course.
- Cut autograder runtime in **half** across all test cases by removing redundant runs and caching builds.

Technical Skills

Security: Program analysis, reverse engineering, binary exploitation, exploit development
Systems: Linux kernel, eBPF, IMA, TPM, RCU, LLVM, Cilium, container networking
Languages: C, C++, Python, Go, Bash, x86 and RISC-V Assembly, SystemVerilog
Certifications: OSED, OSCP+, Certified CyberDefender (CCD)